

Dame Lark and the day of helmets

Knight's story • 3-4 years old



The Morning Bell

The sun woke the castle with a soft glow.

Birds sang on the high stone walls.

Flags stirred in the kind, light wind.

Dame Lark opened her eyes.

She was a brave knight.

She was a kind knight.

She was a wise knight.

She put on her soft leather boots.

She tied her hair with a bright ribbon.

Today was a big day.

Today was the Day of Helmets.

All the helmets must be hung in the Great Hall.

They must shine in a long, neat line.

They must be ready before the sunbell rings.

Dame Lark smiled.

“This is my quest,” she said.

“For friends. For the castle. For the day.”

Her heart felt warm and steady.

She walked out to the quiet yard.

Her horse, Brindle, snorted hello.

Dame Lark patted his soft nose.

“We have work,” she said.

“It is good work.”

Squire Pip ran to her with a small hop.

He held a tiny wooden helmet.

It was for practice.

“My hands shake,” he said.

“They shake so much.”

Dame Lark knelt down.

Her eyes were gentle and bright.

“We will do it together,” she said.

“We will breathe in. We will breathe out.”

They did. In. Out. In. Out.

Pip smiled. His hands did not shake now.

"Thank you," he said.

Dame Lark stood tall.

Her cloak fell smooth.

Her steps were sure.

She walked toward the Great Hall.

The Hall of Helmets

The Great Hall was wide and warm.

Sun made a golden path on the floor.

Long pegs lined the wall.

Helmets waited in rows on tables.

Some were big. Some were small.

Some had a soft feather.

Some had a simple strap.

Sir Rowan waved from the door.

His arm was in a neat blue sling.

"I can polish, but I cannot lift," he said.

"That is all right," said Dame Lark.

“We will use our heads and our hands.”

She made a plan.

“Rowan will polish. Pip will carry. I will hang.”

She looked at Brindle.

“Brindle will stand and be calm. He will help us reach.”

Brindle flicked his ears. He was proud.

They began.

Clink, clink went the helmets.

Rub, rub went the cloth.

Step, breathe, lift, went Dame Lark.

The first peg was high.

Pip looked up.

“It is too high,” he said.

Dame Lark smiled.

“We will be clever,” she said.

She put a clean, folded blanket on Brindle’s back.

She helped Pip climb.

Pip stood with strong little feet.

He held the helmet with both hands.

Dame Lark stood by and kept him safe.

“Ready,” she said.

“Ready,” said Pip.

With a small stretch, the helmet slid onto the peg.

Click.

Pip grinned.

“I did it!”

“We did it,” said Dame Lark.

“For the good of all.”

They moved to the next peg.

This time, a strap was too short.

It would slip off.

Dame Lark looked around.

She saw red ribbon on a basket.

She tied the ribbon to the strap.

She made a neat bow.

Now the strap was long.

The helmet held fast.

“Smart,” said Rowan.

“Kind,” said Pip.

“Together,” said Dame Lark.

The big oak door to the side room was stuck.

Behind it, more helmets waited.

Pip tugged. It did not move.

Rowan pushed with one hand. It did not move.

Dame Lark tapped the hinge.

She listened.

Then she found a wooden spoon on the table.

She slid the spoon under the bottom edge.

She pressed. She made a lever.

Creak, creak, went the door.

It opened with a happy sigh.

“There,” she said softly.

“Sometimes we need a gentle push.”

They carried out more helmets.

A baker came by with warm rolls.

His hat was dusted with flour.

"You look busy," he said.

"We are," said Dame Lark, "but we share."

She broke a roll in half and gave part to Pip.

She gave part to Rowan.

She kept the smallest piece for herself.

"It is sweet," said Pip.

"It is warm," said Rowan.

"It is enough," said Dame Lark.

A little child from the village peeped in.

She held a tiny wooden sword.

Her eyes were wide with joy.

"May I watch?" she asked.

"You may help," said Dame Lark.

"You may cheer."

The child clapped softly.

"Brave. Brave. Brave," she sang.

Her voice was like bells.

The hall felt even brighter.

A helmet with a feather began to droop.

The feather tickled Pip's nose.

He giggled and almost sneezed.

Dame Lark held the helmet steady.

"Steady as the sea," she said.

"Steady as the sun."

She moved slow and sure.

She slid the strap into place.

Clink. Safe.

Now a ladder stood near the far wall.

It wobbled a little on the floor.

Dame Lark knelt down.

She saw a small bit of straw under one leg.

She brushed it away.

She pressed with her hands to test.

No wobble now.

She climbed like a song.

Step. Step. Step.

At the top, she reached a very high peg.

She lifted a great, round helmet.

It was heavy.

Her arms felt warm and strong.

She breathed in. She breathed out.

Her heart said, For friends. For the castle. For the day.

She hung the helmet.

Click.

The sound was brave.

One by one, the pegs filled.

Sunlight slid across shining metal.

The hall began to sing with soft light.

Clink. Click. Shine. Glow.

At last, only one helmet was left.

It was Dame Lark's own helmet.

She looked at it and smiled.

She turned to Pip.

“What do we do first?” she asked.

Pip knew.

“We help others first,” he said.

“We help ourselves last.”

“Yes,” said Dame Lark.

“And now we are ready.”

Pip held the helmet.

Rowan steadied the ladder.

The little child sang, “Brave. Brave. Brave.”

Dame Lark climbed to the highest peg.

She lifted her own helmet high.

She hung it with care.

Click.

The line was complete.

The Gentle Evening

The sunbell rang a soft, clear note.

It sounded like a calm stream.

People came to see.

They smiled and spoke quietly.

“What a neat line,” said the baker.

“What a bright hall,” said the child’s mother.

“What a good quest,” said Rowan.

Dame Lark looked along the wall.

Each helmet told a small, kind story.

Each helmet shone for the good of all.

Her heart felt full and light.

She knelt by Pip.

“You were brave,” she said.

“You were smart,” she said.

“You were strong,” she said.

Pip stood a little taller.

“I had help,” he said.

“We all had help,” said Dame Lark.

“That is the knight’s way.”

They shared cool water from a clay cup.

They ate the last crumb of the warm roll.

They watched the light turn soft and pink.

Brindle sighed and rested his head.

Dame Lark stroked his mane.

“Good friend,” she whispered.

The little child waved her tiny sword.

“Will there be more quests?” she asked.

“Yes,” said Dame Lark.

“Many small quests. Many kind quests.

We will carry. We will share. We will care.

We will hang what needs hanging.

We will lift what needs lifting.

We will shine what needs shining.”

The child nodded.

“Brave,” she said.

“Brave,” said Pip.

“Brave,” said Rowan.

The hall grew quiet.

The helmets glowed like gentle stars.

The castle breathed a long, calm breath.

Dame Lark put away the ladder.

She folded the blanket.

She set the wooden spoon back on the table.

She closed her eyes for a moment.

She listened to the soft sounds.

She felt the peace of a good day.

Her quest was done, and it was done with love.

Night came with silver steps.

The flags rested.

The birds tucked in their heads.

Dame Lark smiled at the shining line.

“For friends. For the castle. For the day,” she whispered.

She walked out into the kind night.

All was bright inside the quiet hall.

All was safe.

All was well.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) What was the special day in the story?

- Day of Helmets
- Day of Shoes
- Day of Stars
- Day of Flowers

2) Who was Dame Lark's horse?

- Brindle
- Bubbles
- Sunny
- Shadow

3) What did Dame Lark use to help with the stuck door?

- A wooden spoon
- A big rock
- A piece of bread
- A feather

4) How did they feel when they finished hanging the helmets?

- Sad
- Tired
- Happy
- Angry

Correct answers:

1) Day of Helmets 2) Brindle 3) A wooden spoon 4) Happy

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Brave: Having courage; not afraid to face danger

Quest: A journey or adventure to achieve a goal

Polish: To make something shiny by rubbing it

Steady: Firm and not shaking; balanced

Neat: Clean and tidy; well arranged

Helmet: A protective covering for the head, often made of metal

Peg: A small stick or hook to hang things on